

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | Microsoft Defender | CISSP

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience in enterprise security operations and engineering. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and have strong hands-on expertise across the Microsoft security stack, including Microsoft Sentinel (using Kusto Query Language (KQL) for detection engineering and threat hunting), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 (M365) Defender. I have deep experience with Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), and certificate-based security including Public Key Infrastructure (PKI) management. Currently, I lead security engineering and operations at the University of the Arts, London (UAL), protecting over 8,000 users across a hybrid infrastructure. I also bring advanced skills in CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) automation, vulnerability management, incident response aligned with NIST SP 800-61, and threat monitoring using the MITRE ATT&CK framework. I am ready to apply this expertise in a permanent hybrid Senior Cyber Security Engineer role where the Microsoft security technology stack sits at the heart of the organisation's security posture.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM):** Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL) - detection rule authoring, dashboards, incident investigation; CrowdStrike NG-SIEM
- **Threat Detection and Monitoring:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), M365 Defender; alert triage, threat hunting, MITRE ATT&CK framework
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** Microsoft Sentinel playbooks, automated enrichment and response workflows, PowerShell scripting
- **Identity and Access Management:** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID, Conditional Access policies, MFA, SSO, Group Policy, Privileged Identity Management (PIM)
- **Public Key Infrastructure (PKI) and Certificate Management:** Certificate lifecycle administration, SSL/TLS certificate management, certificate authority integration
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM platform administration
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) / Extended Detection and Response (XDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover) - Expert level
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus; scanning, prioritisation, and remediation tracking
- **Email Security:** Mimecast gateway administration, anti-phishing, data loss prevention (DLP) policies
- **Mobile Device Management (MDM) / Mobile Application Management (MAM):** Microsoft Intune
- **Incident Response (IR):** NIST SP 800-61 methodology; digital forensics and containment; post-incident review
- **Security Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+
- **Scripting:** PowerShell, KQL, SOAR playbook development

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Lead security engineering and operations across a hybrid environment supporting over 8,000 users, owning the full security technology stack including Microsoft Sentinel SIEM, Microsoft Defender suite, CrowdStrike Falcon, and identity security.

- Design, implement, and maintain Microsoft Sentinel detection rules using Kusto Query Language (KQL), covering identity threats, endpoint anomalies, cloud-based attack patterns, and network indicators of compromise (IoCs).
- Operate and optimise Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), and M365 Defender for comprehensive threat monitoring across endpoints, identity, and cloud workloads.
- Develop and maintain Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks within Microsoft Sentinel, automating enrichment, containment, and notification workflows to reduce mean time to respond.
- Administer Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID, including Conditional Access policy management, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) enforcement, Single Sign-On (SSO) integration, and Privileged Identity Management (PIM) governance.
- Manage certificate lifecycle and Public Key Infrastructure (PKI) operations, including SSL/TLS certificate renewals, certificate authority configuration, and remediation of certificate-related security risks.
- Manage BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) platform, overseeing privileged account provisioning, access reviews, and session recording.
- Lead threat hunting activities using Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, mapping adversary techniques to the MITRE ATT&CK framework and producing actionable threat intelligence reports.
- Lead vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, Pentra Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, and Nessus; prioritise remediation against risk and business impact.
- Lead incident response activities following NIST SP 800-61 methodology, coordinating containment, eradication, recovery, and post-incident review across technical and business stakeholders.
- Administer Mimecast email security gateway, managing anti-phishing, sandboxing, data loss prevention (DLP), and security awareness training campaigns.
- Contribute to security policy development and compliance aligned with ISO 27001, CIS Controls, and Cyber Essentials+ certification.

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 - March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Performed daily security monitoring and incident triage across Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), and CrowdStrike Falcon EDR for an 8,000-user Microsoft 365 environment.
- Authored KQL detection rules and analytic queries in Microsoft Sentinel, building custom dashboards for security operations team visibility and building automated SOAR playbooks to accelerate response.
- Administered Microsoft Defender for Endpoint policies, performing threat and vulnerability assessments, endpoint baseline compliance checks, and incident investigations.
- Managed Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID identity controls: Conditional Access policies, MFA enrollment, SSO application onboarding, and privileged account governance.
- Oversaw certificate management including SSL/TLS certificate renewals and troubleshooting of PKI-related issues across enterprise services.
- Conducted vulnerability scanning and remediation tracking using Tenable.io and Nessus, reporting findings and progress to technical leads.
- Supported incident response procedures aligned with NIST SP 800-61, acting as a first responder for security events and escalating where necessary.
- Administered Mimecast email gateway, managing anti-spam and anti-phishing policies and responding to reported phishing emails across the organisation.
- Managed Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) compliance policies for corporate device fleet.
- Developed SOAR automation workflows that reduced manual effort for high-volume phishing triage and alert enrichment tasks.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 - March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Delivered security engineering and infrastructure support across a SaaS/FinTech environment, covering endpoint security, identity management, and vulnerability assessments.

- Administered identity and access controls supporting MFA and SSO rollout for corporate applications, ensuring secure authentication across cloud and on-premises services.
- Managed certificate lifecycle across internal and external-facing services, coordinating renewals and investigating certificate-related security incidents.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments and collaborated with development teams to remediate identified security weaknesses across cloud and on-premises systems.
- Implemented and maintained security policies and procedures aligned with organisational risk requirements, contributing to IT governance and audit readiness.
- Supported security incident investigations and contributed to improving the organisation's detection and response capabilities.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed and operationalised Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), and M365 Defender across an 8,000-user estate, establishing comprehensive threat visibility across endpoints, identity, and cloud workloads.
- Built a library of over 30 custom Microsoft Sentinel KQL detection rules covering identity attacks, lateral movement, and cloud-based threat patterns, improving detection coverage across the MITRE ATT&CK framework.
- Reduced mean time to detect and respond to security incidents through automated SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, eliminating manual triage steps from high-volume alert types including phishing and brute-force attacks.
- Led organisation-wide Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) exercise, identifying critical gaps in Microsoft Defender and network security controls, and presenting a prioritised remediation roadmap to leadership.
- Achieved Cyber Essentials+ certification by leading technical control implementation and documentation across network, endpoint, identity, and patch management domains.
- Delivered proactive threat hunt that identified a previously undetected persistence mechanism within the Azure Active Directory environment, leading to full remediation and improved identity monitoring rules.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)